

RIGHT

1. Passage anchors

The passage uses **right** twice:

> “That sentence hit me at exactly **the right time**.”

and later:

> “Mrs. Chan gave me a nudge in **the right direction**...”

These belong to the same broad semantic branch: **correct / appropriate / suitable**.

Passage meaning 1: the right time

right = most suitable or appropriate for the situation

恰當的；合適的；正好的

> **at exactly the right time**

> = **恰好在最適當的時機**

The sentence affected the speaker so strongly partly because it came at the moment when they most needed to hear it.

Practice

1. Her advice came at **the right time**.

她的建議來得**正是時候**。

2. Sometimes one encouraging comment at **the right moment** can change your attitude.

有時候，在**恰當的時刻**一句鼓勵的話就能改變你的態度。

2. Passage meaning 2: the right direction

> “...gave me a nudge in **the right direction**.”

right = correct, beneficial, or appropriate

正確的；適當的

the right direction here is metaphorical:

= a course of action or development that is beneficial or appropriate

正確的方向；合適的發展方向

Practice

1. Her feedback pointed me in **the right direction**.

她的回饋讓我朝**正確的方向**前進。

2. I was still uncertain, but at least I was moving in **the right direction**.

我仍然有些不確定，但至少我正在朝**正確的方向**前進。

Core meanings of RIGHT

3. right — correct; not wrong

= correct according to facts, rules, calculations, or expectations

正確的；對的

Examples

1. Your answer is **right**.

你的答案是**對的**。

2. I'm not sure whether I made **the right calculation**.

我不確定自己的計算是否**正確**。

Opposite

wrong = 錯的

4. be right about something

= have a correct opinion, belief, prediction, or judgment

對.....判斷正確；說對了

Examples

1. You were **right about the weather**.

你對天氣的判斷是**對的**。

2. She was **right about him** from the beginning.

她從一開始對他的判斷就是**正確的**。

5. be right that...

= be correct in believing or saying that something is true

說 / 認為.....是對的

Examples

1. You were **right that we needed more time**.

你說我們需要更多時間，這個判斷是**對的**。

2. She was **right to be cautious**.

她保持謹慎是**對的**。

6. get something right

= do, understand, remember, or answer something correctly

做對；答對；弄對

Examples

1. I finally **got the answer right**.

我終於**答對了**。

2. It took several attempts to **get the pronunciation right**.

試了好幾次才把發音**說對**。

Very common.

7. get it right

= do something correctly or successfully

做對；弄對

Examples

1. Don't worry if you don't **get it right** the first time.

第一次沒有**做對**也不用擔心。

2. We need to **get this right**.

我們必須把這件事**做好 / 做對**。

Appropriate or suitable

8. right — appropriate for a particular purpose or situation

= most suitable or appropriate

****合適的；恰當的****

This is the main passage branch.

Examples

1. You need the ****right tools**** for the job.

這份工作需要****合適的工具****。

2. She is the ****right person**** to ask.

她是最****適合詢問的人****。

9. the right person

= the appropriate or best-suited person in a particular situation

****合適的人；適當人選****

Examples

1. He is the ****right person for the job****.

他是這份工作的****合適人選****。

2. I'm not sure I'm the ****right person to answer that question****.

我不確定自己是不是回答那個問題的****適當人選****。

10. the right thing

= the correct, appropriate, or morally proper action

****正確的事；該做的事****

Examples

1. I think you did ****the right thing****.

我覺得你做了****正確的事****。

2. Telling the truth was **the right thing to do**.

說實話是**應該做的事**。

This may combine practical correctness with morality.

11. the right time / moment

= the most suitable moment for something

適當的時機；正是時候

Examples

1. This is not **the right time** to discuss money.

現在不是談錢的**適當時機**。

2. We were waiting for **the right moment** to tell her.

我們一直在等待告訴她的**合適時機**。

This is the exact passage use.

12. right for someone / something

= suitable for a particular person, purpose, or situation

適合.....的

Examples

1. This course may not be **right for everyone**.

這門課不一定**適合每個人**。

2. We need to decide whether this approach is **right for the project**.

我們需要判斷這種方法是否**適合這個專案**。

Morality

13. right — morally good, fair, or acceptable

= morally correct

正當的；**對的**；符合道德的

Examples

1. It is **right** to help someone in need.
幫助有需要的人是**應該的**。

2. She wanted to do what was **right**.
她想做**正確、正當的事**。

This is distinct from factual correctness.

14. right and wrong

= moral correctness and incorrectness

是非；對錯

Examples

1. Children gradually learn the difference between **right and wrong**.
孩子逐漸學會分辨**是非對錯**。

2. The issue is not simply a matter of **right and wrong**.
這個問題並不只是單純的**是非問題**。

15. do right by someone

= treat someone fairly or properly

公平對待某人；善待某人

Examples

1. He wanted to **do right by his family**.
他想要**好好對待自己的家人**。

2. The company should **do right by its employees**.
公司應該**公平對待員工**。

Established expression, somewhat informal.

Direction and position

16. right — the direction opposite left

= on or toward the side that is opposite the left side

****右邊的；向右的****

Examples

1. Raise your ****right hand****.

舉起你的****右手****。

2. Turn ****right**** at the traffic lights.

在紅綠燈處****右轉****。

This is a completely distinct core meaning.

17. the right — the right-hand side or direction

****右邊；右方****

Examples

1. The bank is on ****the right****.

銀行在****右邊****。

2. Look to ****the right****.

看向****右方****。

18. on the right

= situated on the right-hand side

****在右邊****

Examples

1. The door ****on the right**** leads to the kitchen.

****右邊的****門通往廚房。

2. The person ****on my right**** is my colleague.

我****右邊****的人是我的同事。

19. right-hand

= located on, involving, or designed for the right side

****右邊的；右手的****

Examples

1. Use the ****right-hand lane****.

使用****右側車道****。

2. The controls are on the ****right-hand side****.

控制裝置位於****右側****。

Exactness and precision

20. right — exactly

As an adverb, ****right**** can mean ****exactly / directly / completely****, especially in informal English.

****正好；恰好；就在****

Examples

1. She was standing ****right behind me****.

她就站在我****正後方****。

2. The bus stopped ****right outside the hotel****.

公車就停在飯店****正外面****。

21. right here / right there

= exactly here / exactly there

****就在這裡 / 就在那裡****

Examples

1. Put the box ****right here****.

把箱子放****就在這裡****。

2. I left my keys ****right there****.

我的鑰匙就放在****那裡****。

The word intensifies exact location.

22. right now

= at this exact moment; immediately

現在；此刻；立刻

Examples

1. I'm busy **right now**.

我**現在**很忙。

2. I need an answer **right now**.

我**現在立刻**需要答案。

Depending on context:

* **at this moment**

* **immediately**

23. right before / after

= immediately before or after

就在.....之前 / 之後

Examples

1. She called me **right before the meeting**.

她在會議**開始前不久**打給我。

2. It started raining **right after we left**.

我們離開後**馬上**就開始下雨了。

24. right in the middle / centre

= exactly in the middle

正中央；正中間

Examples

1. He stopped ****right in the middle of the road****.

他停在馬路****正中央****。

2. The table stood ****right in the centre of the room****.

桌子就放在房間的****正中央****。

Immediate or complete emphasis

25. right away

= immediately

****立刻；馬上****

Examples

1. I'll do it ****right away****.

我****馬上****去做。

2. Call me ****right away**** if anything changes.

如果有任何變化，請****立刻****打給我。

Very common, especially in North American English.

26. right off

= immediately; from the beginning, especially in some fixed constructions

****立即；一開始就****

Examples

1. I knew ****right off**** that something was wrong.

我****馬上****就知道有問題。

2. We liked each other ****right off the bat****.

我們****一開始****就很合得來。

More informal and regionally variable.

Rights and entitlement

27. a right — something a person is morally or legally entitled to

= an entitlement or freedom that a person is allowed to have, do, or receive

****權利****

This is another major distinct noun meaning.

Examples

1. Everyone has the ****right to express an opinion****.

每個人都有表達意見的****權利****。

2. Employees have certain legal ****rights****.

員工具有一些法律****權利****。

28. the right to do something

= legal or moral entitlement to do something

****做某事的權利****

Examples

1. You have the ****right to refuse****.

你有****拒絕的權利****。

2. Everyone should have the ****right to be heard****.

每個人都應該有****被聽見的權利****。

29. human rights

= fundamental rights regarded as belonging to every person

****人權****

Examples

1. The organization works to protect ****human rights****.

該組織致力於保障****人權****。

2. Freedom of expression is widely discussed as a ****human right****.

言論自由常被討論為一項****人權****。

30. legal rights

= rights recognized or protected by law

****法律權利；法定權利****

Examples

1. You should understand your ****legal rights****.
你應該了解自己的****法律權利****。
2. The agreement does not remove your ****legal rights****.
這份協議不會剝奪你的****法定權利****。

31. have every right to do something

= be completely justified or entitled to do something

****完全有權.....；完全有理由.....****

Examples

1. You have ****every right to be upset****.
你****完全有理由感到不高興****。
2. She has ****every right to ask questions****.
她****完全有權提出問題****。

Notice that this can express either entitlement or justified feeling.

32. within your rights

= legally or legitimately entitled to act in a certain way

****在你的權利範圍內；你完全有權****

Examples

1. You are ****within your rights**** to refuse the request.
你****完全有權****拒絕這項要求。
2. The customer was ****within her rights**** to complain.
那名顧客提出投訴是****她的正當權利****。

Putting something right

33. put something right

= correct, repair, or resolve something that is wrong

****糾正；修好；解決****

Examples

1. We need to ****put this mistake right****.

我們需要****糾正這個錯誤****。

2. The company promised to ****put things right****.

公司承諾會****把問題處理好****。

Especially common in British English.

34. set something right

= correct a mistake, misunderstanding, injustice, or bad situation

****糾正；導正；使恢復正常****

Examples

1. She wanted to ****set the record right****.

她想要****澄清事實****。

2. It may take years to ****set things right****.

可能需要好幾年才能****把事情導回正軌****。

Back to a proper state

35. right something

As a verb, ****right**** can mean:

= restore something to a correct, upright, or proper position

****扶正；使恢復正常****

Examples

1. They managed to **right the overturned boat**.
他們設法把翻覆的船**扶正**。

2. The ship slowly **righted itself**.
船慢慢地**恢復直立**。

This is established but lower-frequency than the adjective.

36. right a wrong

= correct or compensate for an injustice
糾正錯誤；彌補不公

Examples

1. He wanted to **right an old wrong**.
他想要**彌補過去的不公**。

2. The new policy was intended to **right past wrongs**.
新政策旨在**糾正過去的不公正**。

Here both **right** and **wrong** function in their moral/judicial sense.

Noun: blow or punch

37. a right

In boxing or fighting:

= a punch delivered with the right hand
右拳

Examples

1. He landed a powerful **right**.
他打出了一記強力的**右拳**。

2. The boxer followed the jab with a **right**.
拳擊手刺拳之後接了一記**右拳**。

Specialized but established.

Fixed expressions

38. all right / alright

A. satisfactory / acceptable

****還可以；沒問題****

1. The food was ****all right****.
食物****還可以****。

B. safe / healthy

****沒事；安好****

2. Are you ****all right****?
你****還好嗎？****

C. agreement

****好；可以****

3. ****All right****, let's begin.
****好吧****，我們開始。

****alright**** is widespread, especially informally, though ****all right**** remains the safer form in formal writing.

39. right on time

= at exactly the scheduled or expected time

****準時；正好按時****

Examples

1. The train arrived ****right on time****.
火車****準時****抵達。
2. She showed up ****right on time**** for the interview.
她面試時****準時到達****。

Compare with the passage:

* **the right time** = 適當時機

* **right on time** = 準時

These should not be confused.

40. serve someone right

= say that someone deserves an unpleasant consequence because of their behavior

活該；罪有應得

Examples

1. It **serves him right** for ignoring the warning.
他不理會警告，現在這樣也是**活該**。
2. "You missed the bus?" "***Serves you right** for leaving so late."
「你沒搭上公車？」 「誰叫你那麼晚才出門，**活該**。」

Informal and often unsympathetic.

41. right up someone's street / alley

= exactly suited to someone's interests or abilities

正合某人的興趣；正對某人的胃口

Examples

1. This course sounds **right up your alley**.
這門課聽起來**正合你的興趣**。
2. A job involving numbers would be **right up his street**.
與數字有關的工作會**非常適合他**。

up someone's alley is especially common in American English; **up someone's street** is common in British English.

42. right under someone's nose

= very close or obvious, yet unnoticed

****就在眼前卻沒發現****

Examples

1. The keys were ****right under my nose**** the whole time.

鑰匙一直****就在我眼前****。

2. The answer was ****right under our noses****.

答案其實一直****近在眼前****。

Related forms

43. rightly

= correctly, appropriately, or justifiably

****正確地；適當地；理所當然地****

Examples

1. She ****rightly pointed out**** that the data were incomplete.

她****正確地指出****資料並不完整。

2. He was ****rightly proud**** of his achievement.

他對自己的成就感到自豪是****理所當然的****。

44. rightfully

= justly or according to a legitimate/legal entitlement

****正當地；合法地；理應地****

Examples

1. The property ****rightfully belongs to her****.

這項財產****依法 / 理應屬於她****。

2. He demanded what was ****rightfully his****.

他要求取回****理應屬於自己的東西****。

Distinction

****rightly**** often concerns correctness or justification.

****rightfully**** emphasizes legitimate entitlement or justice.

45. rightful

= legally or morally proper; having a legitimate claim

****合法的；正當的；應有的****

Examples

1. She was recognized as the ****rightful owner****.

她被確認為****合法所有人****。

2. The item was returned to its ****rightful place****.

那件物品被放回它****應在的位置****。

46. righteousness

= the quality of being morally right or just

****正義；正直；正當性****

Examples

1. The story explores ideas of justice and ****righteousness****.

這個故事探討正義與****正直****等概念。

2. His sense of moral ****righteousness**** was very strong.

他的道德****正義感****很強。

Often literary, religious, or formal.

47. righteous

= morally right or justified; sometimes describing someone strongly convinced of their moral correctness

****正義的；正當的****

Examples

1. He felt ****righteous anger**** at the injustice.

面對不公，他感到**正當的憤怒**。

2. The character sees himself as a **righteous defender** of the weak.

那個角色把自己視為弱者的**正義捍衛者**。

This is useful but semantically somewhat removed from everyday **right**.

High-value contrasts

48. right vs correct

Both can mean **正確的**.

correct

= factually, technically, or formally accurate

正確的

right

= correct, but also appropriate, suitable, or morally good

對的；合適的；正當的

Compare:

> That is the **correct answer**.

> 那是**正確答案**。

> She is the **right person for the job**.

> 她是這份工作的**合適人選**。

correct person for the job is possible in limited contexts but does not normally express suitability as naturally as **right person**.

49. right vs appropriate

right

is broader and more conversational.

appropriate

specifically means suitable for the circumstances.

適當的；恰當的

Compare:

> It wasn't **the right time** to ask.
> 那不是詢問的**好時機 / 適當時機**。

> His comment was not **appropriate** for the occasion.
> 他的話不**適合那個場合**。

In the passage, **right time** is very close to **appropriate time**.

50. right vs suitable

suitable

= having the qualities needed for a particular purpose

合適的 ; 適用的

right

can express a stronger sense of “the particular one that fits best.”

Compare:

> We need **suitable equipment**.
> 我們需要**合適的設備**。

> We need **the right equipment**.
> 我們需要**正確 / 最合適的設備**。

51. right vs true

right

often evaluates an answer, belief, decision, or judgment.

true

describes a statement or fact that corresponds to reality.

Compare:

> You were **right**.
> 你說對了 / 你判斷正確。

> What you said was **true**.

> 你所說的事情是真的。

They overlap, but they are not interchangeable everywhere.

52. right vs just

In moral contexts:

****right****

= morally correct

****對的；正當的****

****just****

= fair and morally justified, especially in how people are treated

****公正的；正義的****

A decision can be both ****right**** and ****just****, but ****just**** more specifically emphasizes fairness.

Important ambiguity: “right time”

53. the right time vs right on time

These look similar but mean different things.

the right time

= the appropriate moment

****適當的時機****

> She called at ****the right time****.

> 她在****最適當的時候****打來。

right on time

= exactly punctually

****準時****

> She arrived ****right on time****.

> 她****準時****抵達。

Passage

> “...at exactly **the right time**.”

means **the most appropriate moment**, not merely that the teacher’s words were punctual.

Meaning map

right has several major branches that should be kept separate.

Correctness

right answer

→ **正確的**

Suitability

right person / right time

→ **合適的；恰當的**

Morality

do the right thing

→ **正當的；應該的**

Direction

turn right

→ **向右**

Precision/intensification

right here / right now

→ **正好；就在；立即**

Entitlement

have the right to...

→ **權利**

Restoration

right a boat / right a wrong

→ **扶正；糾正**

Although some of these share historical connections, they function as clearly distinct modern

learner meanings.

Passage recap

The passage contains two especially useful examples.

1.

> “That sentence hit me at exactly **the right time**.”

Here:

right = **most appropriate or suitable**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **最恰當的** *

* **最合適的** *

* naturally: **那句話恰好在我最需要的時候觸動了我** *

2.

> “Mrs. Chan gave me a nudge in **the right direction**.”

Here:

right = **correct / appropriate / beneficial**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **正確的方向** *

* **合適的方向** *

* contextually: **她推了我一把，讓我朝正確的方向前進** *

MCQ-ready distinction

right can mean:

* **correct** → 正確的

* **appropriate / suitable** → 合適的、恰當的

* **morally proper** → 正當的、應該的

* **opposite of left** → 右邊的

* **exactly / immediately** → 正好、就在、立刻

* **entitlement** ^{*(noun)*} → 權利

In **“the right time,”** the intended meaning is:

appropriate / suitable

恰當的；最合適的